PAISAPATH

Every Choice Has a Story

M1 — HIGH-LEVEL APPROACH

TEAM **Cache me if you can**
EVENT Megathon | IIIT Hyderabad
PROBLEM Vanguard — Community Stewardship

> THE GUIDING IDEA
>
> *Even a student with **zero financial knowledge** should feel curious, comfortable and excited to learn financial literacy through an interactive game.*

OUR PROMISE

No shaming, intimidating jargon or "wrong person" labels. Every answer is a chance to learn, in simple and respectful language.

A Abstract

How PaisaPath turns money skills into a story

PaisaPath is an inclusive, story-driven financial-literacy simulator for school-age learners, especially those with limited access to financial education. Familiar situations — receiving ₹200, choosing between a need and a want, saving for a goal, comparing a savings option or spotting a suspicious message — become interactive missions. Students make **fictional financial decisions, see the consequences, learn from mistakes and replay** each scenario, all without real-world financial risk. A friendly interest-and-comfort check personalises the examples *before* any finance question appears, so learners with little or no prior knowledge feel at ease. Instead of marking answers simply right or wrong, PaisaPath explains trade-offs, celebrates good reasoning and suggests one small next step. Levels, XP and badges show growth, while optional voice, read-aloud and sign-language support keep every learner included.

B Problem Understanding

Our reading of the challenge

WHO WE DESIGN FOR

- School-age learners with **limited access** to financial education
- Students with **no prior knowledge** who may feel nervous about money
- Learners who need text, audio, visual or sign-language options

WHAT GETS IN THE WAY

- Jargon-heavy, exam-style lessons feel **intimidating**
- Fear of being judged for a "wrong" answer stops practice
- Real-money mistakes are **costly**, so learning by doing is risky

WHAT PAISAPATH MUST DO

- Offer **safe practice** with fictional money and replay
- Show consequences in simple, respectful language
- Personalise examples; keep every format **optional**

C Solution Approach — Learner Journey

Four steps, one replayable loop

01 CONNECT *Set up*

Choose language, accessibility preferences, interests and mood — sports, films, hobbies or role models.

02 DISCOVER *Personalise*

A friendly 4–5 question warm-up checks interests and comfort, then gentle baseline questions estimate familiarity.

03 PLAY *Decide*

Short missions: Wallet Warrior (budgeting), Goal Guardian (saving), Future Lab (risk, time) and Scam Detective (safety).

04 REFLECT *Learn & level up*

See consequences, a plain-language explanation, a next step, XP and badges — then replay with a different choice.

D Learning Missions

Four short missions, all with fictional money

MISSION	WHAT THE LEARNER DOES	WHAT THEY LEARN
Wallet Warrior Budgeting	Manage a fictional ₹200 budget; respond to a need, a want and an unexpected expense.	Needs vs. wants, planning, trade-offs and flexible budgeting.
Goal Guardian Saving	Choose a goal and set aside small amounts while handling tempting purchases.	Saving habits, emergency funds and goal planning.
Future Lab Risk & time	Compare fictional futures: how time, risk and regular contributions may change outcomes.	Risk, diversification and basic SIP/compounding — no real transactions or personalised investment advice.
Scam Detective Safety	Inspect mock messages and choose safe next steps before sharing money or information.	Pressure tactics, suspicious links and safer digital-payment habits.

E Proposed High-Level Architecture

AI is optional — core missions work without it

LEARNER INTERFACE
what the learner sees

- Responsive web UI; **one focused screen** at a time
- Large, readable controls and animated cards
- Learner profile at top-right
- Optional **reduced-motion** and sound controls

GAME & LEARNING LOGIC
how a mission unfolds

1. Onboarding & short quiz
2. Baseline snapshot
3. Mission choices
4. Deterministic scenario outcomes
5. Supportive explanations
6. XP, badges & skill progress

DATA & AI SERVICES
what stores and explains

Backend API + database — preferences, attempts, progress

AI helper — simple-language explanations, optional voice

Fallback guidance — core missions work if AI is unavailable

F Inclusion, Personalisation & Motivation

No single format is ever required

Accessible by choice

Optional **PaisaPath Voice**: speak a question, hear a spoken answer. Read-aloud narrates text and choices, and sound can be switched off. Keyboard navigation, visible focus, readable contrast and reduced motion are built in.

Different communication needs

Short **sign-language explainer videos** with captions and plain text alongside. Supports blind/low-vision and deaf/hard-of-hearing learners, and anyone who prefers text, audio or visual cues — no single format is required.

Learner-first personalisation

4–5 friendly questions on interests, mood and learning style, then a short non-judgmental baseline. Familiar examples — sports, films, family goals, snacks, travel — keep it **relevant, not like an exam**.

Progress that motivates

The profile shows level, XP, badges, mission history and skill indicators for budgeting, saving, investing concepts and safety. A **"Financial Fork"** compares two fictional paths; thoughtful choices are praised, never shamed.

G Testing & Validation Plan

Planned checks for the working MVP

TEST AREA	PLANNED CHECK	SUCCESS INDICATOR
Functional Walkthrough	Run missions end-to-end; test outcomes, replay, XP, badges, profile updates and API/database persistence.	No broken navigation; saved progress matches choices.
Learning & clarity Peer observation	Ask a small group to explain one takeaway; observe whether instructions work without prior knowledge.	Learners describe a practical takeaway in their own words.
Accessibility Checklist audit	Test keyboard-only use, read-aloud/voice toggles, captions/transcripts, contrast, mobile layout, reduced motion.	Core missions do not depend only on sound, colour or animation.
Reliability & safety Edge-case tests	Test slow/no network, missing AI key, empty inputs, repeated attempts; keep all scenarios fictional.	Fallback explanations work; no real-money action or sensitive-data request.

H MVP Scope & Expected Outcome

What we prioritise in 24 hours

24-HOUR MVP PRIORITY

- ✓ Polished onboarding
- ✓ Short baseline quiz
- ✓ ₹200 budgeting mission with consequence replay
- ✓ Ask PaisaPath helper
- ✓ Profile and XP progress
- ✓ Essential accessibility controls

If time allows: sign-language clips and additional missions.

EXPECTED OUTCOME

*A learner with little or no financial knowledge can practise everyday choices safely, understand consequences and leave with more confidence — **not just a score.***